

DIY and Hacking. In another interesting way to perceive it, Maker Hardware can perhaps be seen as the merging of the artistic Craft culture with the more hardcore Engineering Workshop culture. So they aren't distinct enough to have no overlaps and neither are they so similar that they can't be distinguished from each other.

The Instruments of Freedom – Open-Source Hardware

Closely coupled with the maker movement is the idea of Open-source hardware. This is not hardware that is sold freely. Rather, Open-Source hardware is the hardware whose design is easily separable into components and can be legally made and modified by anyone who possesses the design and the required artefacts. Not just the hardware, even the logic and programming that runs within it needs to come under the terms of free software to provide the complete freedom to change the hardware as required. As you see, it is not the hardware itself, but rather its design that falls under the concept of open source. If we compare this understanding to the four freedoms of open source software, the following hardware analogy of the same is reached.

The four freedoms of Open Source hardware

- ♦ The freedom to use the hardware design for any purpose.
- ♦ Freedom to study how the hardware works and change it according to one's needs. Access to blueprints and schematics is a pre condition for this.
- ♦ The freedom to make and redistribute copies of the original hardware to help others.
- ♦ The freedom to redistribute a modified version of the hardware. Access to blueprints and schematics is a pre condition for this.

The hacker movement would

not have reached its current momentum without the widespread use and acceptance of Open Source Software. Hence, the importance of hardware



The accepted logo of Open Source Hardware